

RAGHU RAI

"MARTYRDOM... IS ONLY A BEGINNING"

What does it matter if I die "lying down or standing up", said Indira Gandhi once. When two of her Sikh bodyguards killed her, it did, for those trapped in the ensuing riots. She had been advised to change her Sikh bodyguards, to which she had replied, "Isn't India secular?"



RAJIV RAJ

Rajiv Gandhi, the heir to the Congress throne, won the year-end elections with a landslide margin. He set a record of winning 401 Lok Sabha seats out of 508.



FIRE IN THE AIR

It took moments for the lethal methyl-isocyanate (MIC) gas to leak out of the storage tanks at the Union Carbide factory into the pre-dawn air of Bhopal on December 3, killing 3,000 overnight and 15,000 from related illnesses since then.

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- In one of the largest battles of the Iran-Iraq war, the two armies clashed and inflicted more than 25,000 fatalities on each other. The US accused Iraq of using nerve agent tabun against Iran.
- The USSR announced its boycott of the Los Angeles Summer Olympics.
- American space shuttle astronauts, Bruce McCandless II and Robert L. Stewart, went on the first ever untethered space walk.
- Desmond Tutu (below), black Anglican Archbishop in South Africa, won the Nobel Peace Prize for his non-violent struggle for racial equality.

AP



Rs 10

crore was the cost of reconstruction of the Golden Temple after it was destroyed in Operation Blue Star. This included the cost of the 40 kg of gold donated by the state and the Central governments.